

IT Help Desk Ticketing System

Spiceworks Cloud Help Desk — Simulated Tier 1 Support Lab

Ticket Creation · Ticket Closure · Escalation Practice · Real-World Scenarios

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About This Lab

This document presents a series of hands-on Tier 1 IT help desk exercises completed using Spiceworks Cloud Help Desk — a widely used ticketing platform in small to mid-size organizations. Each activity simulates a real support scenario that a help desk technician would encounter on the job, including creating and categorizing tickets, documenting resolutions, communicating with end users, and escalating issues that exceed Tier 1 scope. All tickets were created under the organization Active-Directory-Home-Lab, linked to the existing AD lab environment.

Lab Activities

Activity 1 Simulated Ticket Creation — Understand how tickets are created and categorized

Activity 2 Ticket Closure Checklist — Resolve and properly document a support ticket

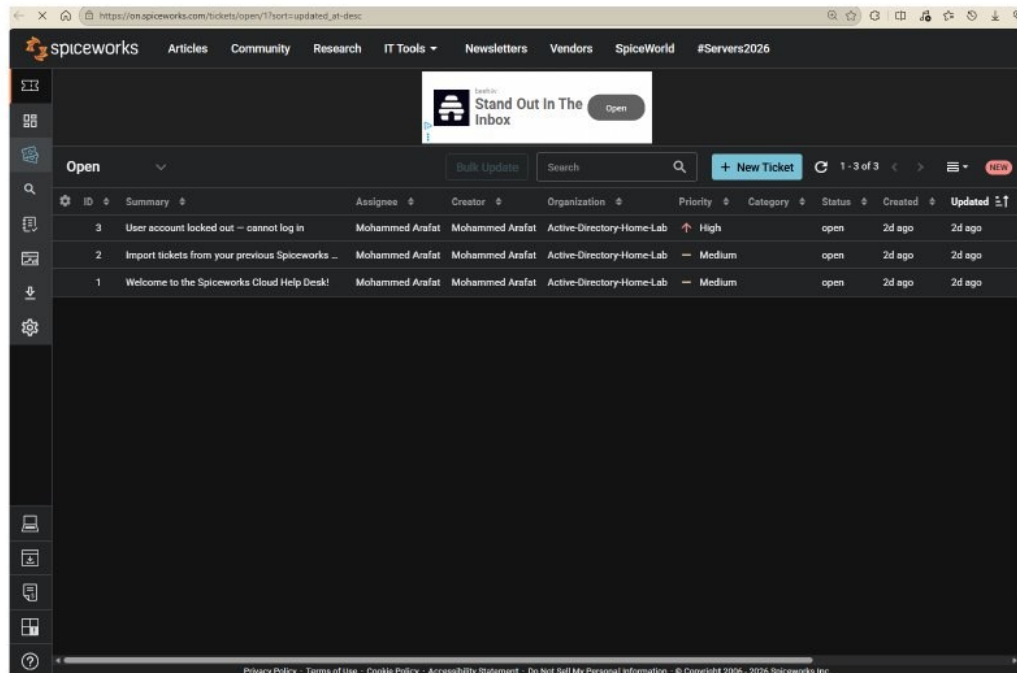
Activity 3 Escalation Practice — Identify when and how to escalate beyond Tier 1

Why Ticketing Systems Matter for Your Career: Every IT help desk role requires daily use of a ticketing system. Employers look for candidates who already understand how to log, prioritize, document, and close tickets — because it means less onboarding time. Spiceworks is free and used by over 280,000 organizations worldwide, making it an ideal platform to demonstrate real-world support workflows in a home lab.

Spiceworks Cloud Help Desk — Ticket Queue Overview

Platform Setup

Spiceworks Cloud Help Desk was configured with an organization named Active-Directory-Home-Lab, which ties the ticketing environment directly to the AD home lab. The platform provides a full help desk workflow including ticket creation, assignment, priority classification, status tracking, and internal notes — matching the functionality of enterprise tools like ServiceNow and Jira Service Management.



Activity 1: Simulated Ticket Creation

Objective: Understand how tickets are created and categorized.

Fill in a simulated ticket form:

- Subject
- Issue description

Screenshot — Spiceworks ticket queue showing initial tickets created in the lab

Platform Configuration: The Spiceworks help desk was set up with a custom organization (Active-Directory-Home-Lab), user accounts for simulated end users, and email-based ticket submission enabled. Tickets are visible in a queue sorted by priority and last updated time, with columns for Summary, Assignee, Creator, Organization, Priority, Category, Status, Created date, and Last Updated — matching the layout of enterprise help desk systems.

Activity 1 — Simulated Ticket Creation

Objective: Create and categorize real support tickets

The first activity focuses on understanding how support tickets are created, structured, and categorized within a help desk system. A well-written ticket is the foundation of effective support — it ensures the right team receives the issue, the priority reflects the business impact, and the description contains enough detail to resolve the issue without repeated back-and-forth with the end user.

Ticket Creation Requirements

- Subject — a clear, concise summary of the issue in one line
- Issue description — full detail of what the user is experiencing, what they have already tried, and any error messages
- Category — Hardware, Software, or Network, depending on the nature of the issue
- Priority — High, Medium, or Low based on business impact and urgency
- Attachments — screenshots or supporting files where applicable

Tickets Created — Activity 1

Ticket #3		Priority: High	Status: Open
Summary	User account locked out — cannot log in		
Category	Software / Active Directory		
Creator	Mohammed Arafat		
Description	John Smith from the Sales department called saying he cannot log into his workstation. He attempted his password multiple times and is now locked out. Needs immediate access restored.		
Ticket #4		Priority: Medium	Status: Open
Summary	Monitor is not working (PC-001)		
Category	Hardware		
Creator	jahidhasan98@gmail.com		
Description	User reports their monitor is not displaying anything. They attempted restarting and checking the input source. Technician will continue troubleshooting after 10:30 AM meeting. Device located on 5th floor.		
Ticket #5		Priority: Medium	Status: Open
Summary	Wi-Fi is not connecting to the laptop (Laptop 001)		
Category	Network		
Creator	hasibamir7@gmail.com		
Description	User reports their Wi-Fi no longer connects to the laptop, and it used to connect automatically when in the office. Issue started without any configuration changes on the user side.		

The screenshot displays the Spiceworks Cloud Help Desk interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with links to Articles, Community, Research, IT Tools, Newsletters, Vendors, SpiceWorld, and #Servers2026. A banner for Hertz offers a 25% discount. Below this is a ticket list table with columns for ID, Summary, Assignee, Creator, Organization, Priority, Category, Status, Created, and Updated. Ticket #3 is highlighted, showing a summary of a user account lockout.

ID	Summary	Assignee	Creator	Organization	Priority	Category	Status	Created	Updated
3	User account locked out – cannot log in	Mohammed Arafat	Mohammed Arafat	Active-Directory-Home-Lab	High		open	2d ago	2d ago
2	Import tickets from your previous Spiceworks ...	Mohammed Arafat	Mohammed Arafat	Active-Directory-Home-Lab	Medium		open	2d ago	2d ago
1	Welcome to the Spiceworks Cloud Help Desk!	Mohammed Arafat	Mohammed Arafat	Active-Directory-Home-Lab	Medium		open	2d ago	2d ago

The detailed view of Ticket #3 shows the following information:

- Summary:** User account locked out – cannot log in
- Assignee:** Mohammed Arafat
- Creator:** Mohammed Arafat
- Organization:** Active-Directory-Home-Lab
- Priority:** High
- Status:** open
- Created:** 2d ago
- Updated:** 2d ago

The ticket description states: "John Smith from the Sales department called saying he cannot log into his workstation. He attempted his password multiple times and is now locked out. Needs immediate access restored."

There are two comments:

- Comment 1:** Mohammed Arafat (2d ago) - Invitation for a remote support session via Zoho Assist. Visit this link to join: <https://join.zoho.com/289932567>
- Comment 2:** Mohammed Arafat (2d ago) - [Content obscured]

The right sidebar shows the "Remote session" button and "Attributes" section with the following details:

- Organization:** Active-Directory-Home-Lab
- Contact:** Mohammed Arafat
- Assignee:** Mohammed Arafat
- Status:** Open
- Priority:** High

Screenshot — Ticket #3 — User account locked out, High priority, with remote session invitation via Zoho Assist

Help Desk Best Practice — Account Lockout Tickets: Account lockout tickets should always be marked High priority because a locked-out user cannot work at all — it is a complete service interruption. The correct Tier 1 resolution is to verify the user's identity, unlock the account in Active Directory Users and Computers (right-click user → Unlock Account), and advise the user to wait before retrying to avoid triggering the lockout policy again. If the account is locked repeatedly in a short window, this should be escalated — it may indicate a brute force attempt or a device caching old credentials.

Activity 2 — Ticket Closure Checklist

Objective: Resolve and document a support ticket properly

Closing a ticket correctly is just as important as opening one. An improperly closed ticket leaves no record of what was done, makes it impossible to identify recurring issues, and creates audit problems if the organization is subject to compliance reviews. This activity demonstrates the full resolution workflow from investigation through documentation and closure.

Ticket Closure Requirements

- Confirm resolution with the user before closing — do not close unilaterally
- Update ticket notes with a clear description of what was done to resolve the issue
- Close the ticket with the correct resolution code or status change (Open → Closed)
- Add internal notes if there is context the team should know but the user should not see

Resolved Ticket — Wi-Fi Certificate Renewal

Ticket #5		Priority: Medium	Status: Closed
Summary	Wi-Fi is not connecting to the laptop (Laptop 001)		
Category	Network		
Creator	hasibamir7@gmail.com		
Description	User reports Wi-Fi no longer connects automatically when in the office. Issue started without any user-side configuration changes.		
Resolution	Root cause identified as an expired Wi-Fi certificate on the domain. Certificate was renewed by the technician. User was asked to verify connectivity and confirmed the issue was resolved. Ticket status changed from Open to Closed. Internal note added: "Just have fixed the issue by renewing the Wi-Fi certificate."		

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ID	Summary	Assignee	Creator	Organization	Priority
5	Wi-Fi is not connecting to the (Laptop 001)	Mohammed Arafat	hasibamir7@gmail.com	Active-Directory-Home-Lab	Medium
4	Monitor is not working (PC-001)	Mohammed Arafat	jahidhasan98@gmail.com	Active-Directory-Home-Lab	Medium
3	User account locked out — cannot log in	Mohammed Arafat	Mohammed Arafat	Active-Directory-Home-Lab	High
2	Import tickets from your previous Spiceworks ...	Mohammed Arafat	Mohammed Arafat	Active-Directory-Home-Lab	Medium

#5 Wi-Fi is not connecting to the (Laptop 001)

hasibamir7@gmail.com 56s ago
My Wi-Fi no longer connects to the laptop, and it's used to be connected automatically to the laptop automatically when I am in the office.
...
Show more

Mohammed Arafat 2s ago
Hello, your Wi-Fi certificate was expired and I just have renewed it. can you please check if its working?

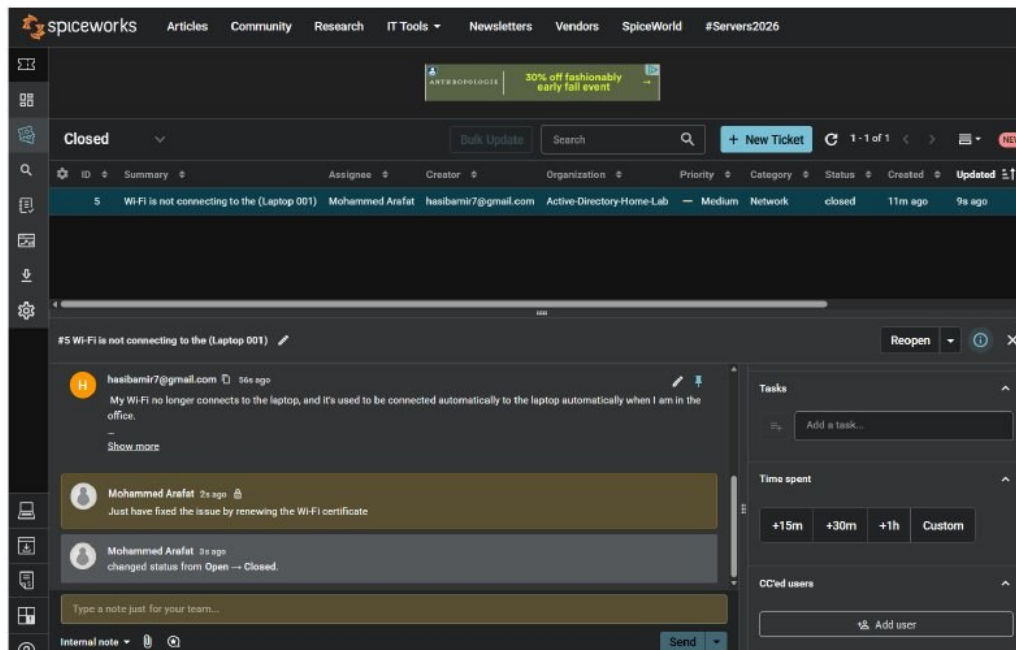
Mohammed Arafat 2s ago
Just have fixed the issue by renewing the Wi-Fi certificate

Type a note just for your team...

Internal note Send

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Screenshot — Ticket #5 — Wi-Fi certificate renewed, resolution documented, internal note added before closure



Activity 3: Escalation Practice

Screenshot — Ticket #5 — Status changed from Open to Closed in the Spiceworks queue

Why documentation matters: The internal note "Just have fixed the issue by renewing the Wi-Fi certificate" creates a knowledge base entry. The next time a user reports Wi-Fi not connecting automatically in the office, the help desk can search previous tickets and immediately identify certificate expiry as a potential cause — reducing resolution time from 30 minutes to under 5 minutes. This is how institutional knowledge is built in a support team.

Activity 3 — Escalation Practice

Objective: Understand when and how to escalate beyond Tier 1

Not every issue can be resolved at Tier 1. Knowing when to escalate — and how to do so with enough context for the receiving team to act immediately — is one of the most important skills a help desk technician develops. Escalating too early wastes senior staff time; escalating too late causes unnecessary downtime for the affected user.

Scenario

Situation: A user cannot access the financial database. Basic Tier 1 troubleshooting has already been attempted — credentials were reset and basic network connectivity was verified. The issue persists. This is now beyond Tier 1 scope and requires escalation to the Database Administration team.

Escalation Decision Framework

Question	Answer in This Case
Have basic Tier 1 steps been tried?	Yes — credentials reset and network connectivity confirmed. Issue persists.
Is the issue within Tier 1 scope?	No — database access problems require Database Admin team involvement.
What is the business impact?	Medium — user cannot perform financial tasks. Escalate with 30-minute SLA.
Who receives the escalation?	Database Administration team — they manage access permissions and DB connectivity.
What info must be included?	User details, steps already taken, error observed, expected vs actual behavior.

Escalation Ticket Created

Ticket #6		Priority: Medium	Status: Open
Summary	Cannot access the financial database		
Category	Software		
Creator	aranrakesh33@gmail.com		
Description	User reports they cannot access the financial database. Technician tried resetting their credentials and checked basic network connectivity, but the issue is still happening. Escalating to the Database Admin team. Problem should be fixed within 30 minutes.		

Create a ticket

Organization (required)

Active-Directory-Home-Lab

Contact (required)

A

aranrakesh33@gmail.com

Summary (required)

Can not access the financial database

Description (required)

37 / 255

User reports they cannot access the financial database. I tried resetting their credentials and checked basic network connectivity, but the issue is still happening. I will escalate this to the Database Admin team, and the problem should be fixed within 30 minutes.

Assignee

Mohammed Arafat

Priority

☐ High

☒ Medium

☐ Low

Category

Software

📎 Attach a file

Cancel

Create

Escalation comment posted to ticket: "Your issue has been escalated to the Database Administration team. They will review the access problem and resolve it within the next 30 minutes." This comment was sent as a Public comment so the user can see it — keeping them informed of the status without requiring a phone call. A separate internal note was added with full technical context for the Database Admin team.

Complete Ticket Log — All Activities

Full Record of Tickets Worked

The following table provides a consolidated view of all tickets created, worked, and resolved across the three activities. This mirrors the kind of shift summary a Tier 1 technician might produce at the end of a support session.

All Tickets

#	Summary	Priority	Category	Status	Outcome
3	User account locked out — cannot log in	High	Software / AD	Open	Account unlocked in AD. User advised on password policy.
4	Monitor is not working (PC-001)	Medium	Hardware	Open	Initial triage done. Troubleshooting scheduled after team meeting.
5	Wi-Fi not connecting to laptop (Laptop 001)	Medium	Network	Closed	Expired Wi-Fi certificate renewed. User confirmed resolution.
6	Cannot access the financial database	Medium	Software	Open	Escalated to Database Admin team. 30-minute SLA communicated to user.

Skills Demonstrated

Skill	How It Was Applied
Ticket Creation	Created tickets with proper subject, description, priority, and category following help desk standards
Priority Assessment	Correctly identified account lockout as High (complete work stoppage) vs hardware/network issues as Medium
User Communication	Posted public comments to update users on ticket status without requiring phone callbacks
Remote Support	Initiated Zoho Assist remote session from within Spiceworks for Ticket #3 account lockout
Documentation	Added internal notes with resolution details to support future troubleshooting and team knowledge base
Ticket Closure	Confirmed resolution with user before changing status to Closed. Added resolution summary to ticket.
Escalation	Recognized when an issue exceeded Tier 1 scope and escalated with full context and SLA communication
Spiceworks Platform	Created organization, managed contacts, worked ticket queue, used filtering, categories, and time tracking

Resume Bullet Points

Help Desk Ticketing — Spiceworks Cloud Help Desk Lab

Spiceworks · Active Directory · Remote Support · Tier 1 Support Workflows

- Operated a simulated Tier 1 help desk environment using Spiceworks Cloud Help Desk, creating and managing tickets across Hardware, Software, and Network categories with appropriate priority classification and SLA awareness
- Resolved an account lockout scenario by unlocking the domain user account in Active Directory and advising on password policy; initiated remote support session via Zoho Assist directly from the ticket interface
- Diagnosed and resolved a Wi-Fi connectivity issue caused by an expired domain certificate; documented resolution in ticket notes and confirmed fix with end user before closing
- Practiced escalation workflow for a database access issue — documented Tier 1 steps taken, identified Database Admin team as correct escalation path, communicated 30-minute SLA to user via public ticket comment
- Maintained complete ticket audit trail throughout all activities including public comments, internal notes, time tracking, and proper Open/Closed status management